



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christian Steward Academy
School Website: <https://christiansteward.education>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS STARTUP

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Christian Steward Academy (Texas, 78621) presents a robust classical Christian program that is deeply anchored in a theological framework, practices a Trivium-based curriculum, and emphasizes Great Books, Socratic dialogue, and the cultivation of virtue. Public materials consistently frame education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty, with explicit references to a biblical worldview, the Paideia approach, and a strong partnership with parents. The school's materials also emphasize the Great Books, liberal arts, languages (Latin/Koine Greek), and a structured progression from grammar to logic to rhetoric. Overall, the school demonstrates a CLASSICAL orientation across most criteria, with one category (Faculty) showing only a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL alignment given current public-facing descriptions. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key strengths include: - Clear religious/metaphysical grounding and a view of education as formation rooted in Christian truth and virtue (Categories 1 and 2). - Strong curriculum signals: Trivium, Great Books, Latin/Greek, Western heritage, and a Paideia-inspired framework (Element 3). - Pedagogy consistently mixes contemplative/memory-centered lower grades with Socratic/seminar-style upper grades and explicit rhetoric development (Element 4). - Active parental partnership and community integration, with explicit language about parents as co-teachers and hosts for family formation (Element 6).

Concrete needle-moving steps are most relevant to the Faculty category (Element 5). While CSA highlights committed teachers and a values-oriented culture, explicit public articulation of the faculty as the "living curriculum" and a formal faculty-formation model is less visible in the material compared to other categories. To reach a fully CLASSICAL alignment in that category, CSA could foreground a more explicit living-curriculum narrative and a formalized teacher profile consistent with classical pedagogy standards.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categories) - Strengthen explicit articulation of the living curriculum in faculty descriptions, including portraits of teacher-mentor models and formal teacher training in classical pedagogy. - Expand on concrete classroom practices that demonstrate the teacher-as-core-of-the-school narrative (e.g., faculty seminars, common-book discussions among staff, public-facing faculty profiles tied to Classical pedagogy outcomes).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot - Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL - Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL - Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

ABSTRACT Christian Steward Academy (CSA) demonstrates a classical Christian orientation across six categories. Religiously and metaphysically, it is anchored in a Christ-centered, biblical worldview with explicit references to truth, virtue, theology, and a Great Books/Paideia framework. The school's stated mission and vision emphasize formation through classical methods rather than mere information transfer, with strong

attention to the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), Great Books, and areas of the liberal arts, including Latin and Greek. Pedagogical practices align with both contemplative and Socratic methods, with a clear progression from chanting and memorization in the Grammar Stage to Socratic discussions and rhetoric in the Rhetoric Stage. Faculty portrayals emphasize committed teachers who nurture the whole person, but public-facing language around the “living curriculum” and a formal faculty-development narrative could be strengthened. Parent involvement and partnership are strongly foregrounded, with explicit calls for parental primacy, co-teaching, and community engagement. Overall, CSA is CLASSICAL, with minor opportunities to deepen the Faculty category toward a fuller classical articulation.

Now, the category-by-category analysis with keyword analysis and scoring follows.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site describes CSA as “Christ-Centered” with education rooted in God’s truth and formation of students to glorify God (e.g., “Christ-Centered Education where all areas of study are rooted in God’s truth aimed at forming children into adults who glorify God and enjoy Him forever.”) - Vision emphasizes preparing students to commit their lives to God and serve others in Jesus Christ’s name. - Mission sections repeatedly frame God as the source of truth and tie education to Christian commitments (e.g., “God is the core foundation and source of all truth,” Colossians quotes). - The Classical/Paideia framing references a biblical worldview, seven Christian virtues, and the Great Books as part of formation. - The emphasis on theology, sacred worldview, and virtue forms a coherent metaphysical basis for education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis (based on Six Elements lexicon) - Positive keywords present: truth; virtue; theology; great conversation; Paideia; liberal education; Western heritage; worship-like language through Christ-centered focus; sacred/civic ethics by scriptural framing (e.g., Great Books as avenue to truth and virtue). - Negative keywords present: None of the specified negative indicators (relativism, secular humanism, morally neutral) appear in public-facing CSA materials.

Why this rating - CSA’s public materials clearly foreground transcendental moral realism anchored in Christian theology, with language about virtue, sacred truth, and a liturgical/covenantal sensibility (through terms like worship, theology, sacred worldview) that aligns with the positive indicators in the Classical lexicon. The combination of Christ-centered formation, a Paideia framework, and Great Books signals a robust CLASSICAL orientation in religious/metaphysical foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes formation over mere information, aiming to form virtue and human flourishing, with references to virtue formation, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. Example lines emphasize formation and classical mission and the Great Conversation. - Several pages describe education as a means to cultivate character and human excellence, not just job-readiness, and stress liberal arts education (Paideia) and classical aims. - Vision/Mission statements frame education as service to God and neighbor, tying purpose to character formation and spiritual formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; cultivation of virtue; human flourishing; wisdom; liberal education; paideia; Great Conversation; telos; contemplation/restfulness; classical heritage. - Negative keywords: none of the listed negative signals (e.g., “college and career ready,” “workforce preparation”) are foregrounded in the public materials.

Why this rating - CSA’s stated goals emphasize virtue/formation, classical liberal education, and exposure to perennial questions (Great Books, Great Conversation), which align with CLASSICAL markers in the lexicon. The absence of explicit workforce-preparation framing in public messaging supports CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium is named as the core (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) with age-appropriate progression, including Latin, Koine Greek, classical languages, and memorization. - Great Books and “the great conversation” are highlighted as central elements of the curriculum. - History is studied broadly (Western Civilization, Biblical/Historical context), with emphasis on primary sources rather than modern social-studies framing. - Omnibus/Quadrivium, Latin/Greek, and a humanities-core oriented curriculum are discussed in depth. - Mission/Academics materials describe a curriculum rooted in biblical worldview, philosophy, theology, history, and classical studies.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; trivium; quadrivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; primary sources; classics; Latin; Greek; history; Western civilization; Socratic texts; recitation; narration; dictation; Omnibus; Paideia; learning from Great Books. - Negative keywords: none of the explicit negative indicators (e.g., “STEM-first framing,” “project-based learning dominance”) appear in the public materials.

Why this rating - CSA's public materials describe a full classical curriculum: Trivium progression, Great Books, classical languages, liberal-arts emphasis, and a historical-cultural scope consistent with classical education. The absence of public statements privileging non-classical curricula strengthens CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower grades emphasize contemplative, memory-based activities (singing, chanting, memorization). - Upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training, including public speaking and thesis defense. - The pedagogy integrates Paideia-inspired seminar-style instruction, and the Great Conversation approach is embedded via Great Books and dialectic discussion. - There is a clear progression from memory-centered, contemplative work to rational-discursive and rhetorical work as students advance.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar; questioning; dialectic; recitation; chanting; memory work; Paideia seminar; rhetoric; debate; capstone orations; seminars; commonplacing (journaling great ideas); liturgical calendar integration. - Negative keywords: none of the explicit negative signals (e.g., “experiential learning focus,” “project-based only,” “constructivist”) are foregrounded.

Why this rating - CSA's pedagogy aligns with classical teaching methods: memory-work and chant in the grammar stage, and Socratic/seminar/rhetoric activities in later years. The presence of a Paideia-style approach and formal rhetoric training supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe teachers as enthusiastic and caring, focusing on nurturing the whole person created in God's image, which indicates virtue-modeling but not yet a full articulation of the living curriculum or a formal faculty-development narrative. - Headmaster/founding leadership details appear (e.g., about Carl Crittendon and Tes), which underscores a committed leadership, but the public-facing materials do not consistently foreground a formal “living curriculum” portrait or a professional classical-faculty development framework. - Where present, language about the faculty is more aligned with general teaching excellence and Christian mentorship, rather than a fully described classical faculty identity (e.g., the explicit portrait-of-the-teacher, living-curriculum concept).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: mentors; guides; model teachers; teachers enthusiastic about subjects; care for students; nurturing the whole person; mission-driven educators. - Negative keywords present: explicit references to “portrait of a teacher,” “living curriculum,” or “faculty of friends” are not clearly foregrounded in public content. The lexicon's negative signals for this category include “facilitators on the side” or “certification-driven jargon without classical context,” which are not evident in CSA's public materials.

Why this rating - CSA demonstrates strong teacher commitment and moral modeling, but a fuller Classical Faculty designation would require explicit articulation of the living-curriculum concept and formal faculty development aligned with classical pedagogy. The absence of that explicit framing places Element 5 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents and describes parents as co-teachers in the educational process. “Education involves a partnership with parents” is explicitly stated. - CSA invites parent formation (reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs) and describes open-campus access and opportunities for families to participate in school life (tours, visits). - The Admissions section emphasizes a family-centered process and ongoing parent engagement; programs highlight family interviews and a shared path to enrollment. - The school communicates with families around values, virtue formation, and Christian stewardship, reinforcing community alignment with classical aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental primacy; parent formation; reading groups; seminars; classical book clubs; open campus; family liturgy alignment; home catechesis; family involvement. - Negative keywords present: none of the negative signals (customer-only framing, minimal parental involvement) are evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - CSA exhibits strong parental engagement and community integration, aligning well with CLASSICAL expectations for parent partnerships and community formation. The explicit parental-lead and formation language supports CLASSICAL, with no overt counter-indicators in the publicly available material.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 5 (Faculty): Publicly articulate the living-curriculum concept and provide a formal, teacher-centric classical-faculty development narrative (e.g., faculty profiles tied to classical pedagogy outcomes, faculty seminars on classical methods, and explicit “portrait of the teacher” materials). This would push Element 5 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.
 - Element 1–4 could be further strengthened by more explicit, public-facing articulation of liturgical/-communal practices (where applicable) and more explicit references to liturgy/worship in the curriculum context, if the school intends to foreground liturgical forms. This could bolster a fuller religious-metaphysical demonstration without changing core content.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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